

Bilateral Treaties

These are agreements between South Africa and one other specific country.

- 1. **South Africa–China Comprehensive Strategic Partnership (2024/2025 Framework):**
This is a cornerstone of South Africa’s economic policy. In late 2025/early 2026, the two nations signed the **Framework Agreement on Joint Development Economic Partnership**. This agreement focuses on increasing bilateral trade (which reached over \$53 billion in 2025), expanding market access for South African agricultural goods, and collaborating on "New Quality Productive Forces" like green energy and digital technology.
- 2. **South Africa–United States Extradition Treaty (2001):**
A long-standing and active legal agreement that allows for the formal surrender of persons accused or convicted of crimes between the two nations. This treaty is frequently cited in high-profile international legal cases and is supported by a related **Mutual Legal Assistance Treaty (MLAT)** to share evidence in criminal investigations.

Multilateral Treaties

These are agreements involving South Africa and three or more other countries.

- 1. **African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA):**
South Africa is a leading member of this landmark agreement, which aims to create a single continental market for goods and services. In **January 2024**, South Africa officially began trading under the AfCFTA preferences, sending its first shipment of locally manufactured goods to other African ports. It is designed to eliminate 90% of tariffs on intra-African trade over time.
- 2. **SADC Protocol on Trade (and its updates):**
As a member of the **Southern African Development Community (SADC)**, South Africa is bound by this protocol which established a Free Trade Area among 16 Southern African nations. It governs the duty-free movement of goods within the region and is a primary tool for South Africa’s regional economic integration.

Summary Table

Type	Example	Key Focus
Bilateral	SA-China Framework Agreement (2025)	Economic growth & market access

Bilateral	SA-USA Extradition Treaty (2001)	Law enforcement & criminal justice
Multilateral	AfCFTA	Continental trade & industrialization
Multilateral	SADC Protocol on Trade	Regional integration in Southern Africa